

Glossary: Developing Front-End Apps with React

Welcome! This alphabetized glossary contains many of the terms in this course. This comprehensive glossary also includes additional industry-recognized terms not used in course videos. These terms are essential for you to recognize when working in the industry, participating in user groups, and in other professional certificate programs.

Estimated reading time: 12 minutes

Term	Definition
Action creators	Functions that create actions.
Actions	JSON objects that contain information about changes that need to be made to the state. For example, a GET action obtains information, a POST action sends information, and a DELETE action removes information.
Angular	Angular is a platform for building mobile and desktop web applications.
App.js	Contains App, which is the root React component that you will add into your HTML page.
Arrow functions	Allow you to declare functions the same way you declare variables.
Asynchronous or async code	Runs in parallel, and an operation can occur while another one is still being processed.
Babel	A special in-memory tool that compiles JSX and interprets it as JavaScript.
Callback	A normal method called once a condition is met.
Central Store	holds the entire application list in the form of the 'state tree'.
Chai	An object that can be used as the assertion library.
Class	A template or blueprint for creating objects.
Class component	Use JavaScript ES6 classes to create class-based components in React.
Component	Core building blocks of React.
Component Lifecycle	A series of four phases make up the lifecycle of a component. These phases are: Initialization, Mounting, Updating, and Unmounting.
Component testing	When you render component trees in a simple test environment and assert their output.
Const	Allows you to declare constants whose values cannot be changed.
Controlled input	Use React to fully control the element by setting and updating the input value directly.
Create React App	Simplifies the process of creating React applications.
Cross-origin requests	Requests that come from multiple sources.
CSS	Cascading style sheets.
Custom Hook	A new composition of one or multiple Hooks.
Document Object Model (DOM)	It defines the logical structure of documents and the way a document is accessed and manipulated.
ECMAScript	A standard used for client-side scripting.
End-to-end testing	A multi-step test that combines multiple units and integrates all tests into one big test. It requires the running of a complete application in a realistic browser environment.
Enzyme	A library that can be added to your testing tools in order to render your React components.
ES	ES is short for ECMAScript, which is a standards organization that creates a wide range of global information and communications technology standards.
ES6	JavaScript adheres to ECMA's specification EcmaScript6.
event	Enable the component to manage document object model (DOM) actions as a result of user interaction on the system.
Front-end frameworks	Are used to create a dynamic client that can connect to the server.
Functional component	Created by writing a JavaScript function.
High-order component	Are used to share logic with other components.
Hooks	Enable functional components to attach local state with it, and this state will be preserved by React when the component re-renders.
HTML	Hypertext markup language.
index.js	Where you will add App to the HTML.
Initialization phase	The first component lifecycle phase. During this phase, the component is constructed with the given Props and default state.
Jest	A JavaScript test runner and assertion library used to test React components. It can be combined with Enzyme or the React Testing Library.

Term	Definition
JSX	JavaScript XML which resembles HTML.
let	Allows you to restrict the scope of variables within the block where they were declared.
Local scope	Is the limited scope.
Local state	One of the two types of React states. Local state lives in a single component and is not used in other components. An example of local state is hiding and showing information. (See Shared state .)
Middleware	Library that connects applications and services.
Mocha	Object that can be used as the test runner.
Mounting Phase	The second component lifecycle phase. During this phase, the JSX is rendered.
NPM	Package manager for the Node JavaScript platform.
onChange	Attribute that controls changes in the form.
Payload property	An optional property that contains some data that is required to perform a task.
Promise	Represents the eventual completion of an asynchronous operation and its return value.
Props	Short for 'properties.' Read-only objects that store attribute values of tags. Used to pass data from parent to child components.
Pure component	Do not depend on or modify the state of variables. Outside their scope.
Push	When a user or software automation moves data from one location to another.
React elements	Used to render the component to DOM.
React Hook form	A form state management and validation library for React web-based applications and React Native mobile applications.
React package	Holds the React source for components and their states and properties.
React Testing Library	A set of helpers that let you test React components without depending on their implementation details. This library is a replacement for Enzyme.
ReactDOM package	This is the glue between React and the DOM.
Reducer	Pure functions that receive the current state and an Action object and return a new state with the actions performed.
Redux	A state management library that is often used with React to handle the state of your application.
Redux Saga	Middleware that uses an ES6 feature called Generators to enable async operations.
Redux Thunk	Middleware that allows to pass functions within action creators to create async Redux.
Ref function	Used to get the form values from DOM.
setState	Updates state of the form input elements.
Shared state	One of the two types of React states. Shared state is shared by multiple components and is complicated. An example of shared state is the list of all orders in an order application. (See Local state .)
Sinon	An object that can be used to test JavaScript logic with objects such as spies, stubs, and mocks.
Snapshot testing	Testing that helps check and verify the component rendering result.
src folder	The main folder in which you will make changes.
State	A plain JavaScript object used by React to represent information about the component's current situation. States help track changes in a component.
Store	Contains the Redux application's current state, other functions, and objects.
subclass	The class that is inheriting one other class.
Subscription	Is triggered in the components whenever the state is updated in the store.
superclass	The class being inherited by the subclass.
Synchronous or sync code	Runs in sequence from top to bottom, and each operation must wait for the previous one to complete before executing.
Testing	A line-by-line review of how code executes. Testing replicates end user actions to ensure features work as intended.
this	Keyword that refers to the current object.
Type property	A string that identifies the action.
Uncontrolled input	Allows the browser to handle most of the form elements and collect data through React's change events.
Unmounting phase	The final component lifecycle phase. During this phase, the component is removed from the page.
Updating phase	The third component lifecycle phase. During this phase, the state of a component is updated, and the application is repainted.

Term	Definition
useContext	Manages context changes and provides the component with access to a context.
useEffect	Manages side effects such as document changes, HTTP, and so on.
useReducer	Manages Redux state changes.
useState	A hook that allows you to use state in your function. It adds state to a function component.



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